

Read The Fine Print

Q My PC configuration is a Pentium 4 at 3 GHz, an original Intel D915GAV motherboard with a Intel(R) 82915G/GV/910GL Express Chipset Family, a display adapter with 128 MB of onboard memory, and 512 MB of DDR 333 MHz RAM with DirectX 9.0c installed. The *Age of Empires 3* Demo runs fine with all the advanced features turned off, but in the later stages of the game, I experience some problems with the smoothness of play. I intend to buy the game, and I want it to run smoothly on my PC. Are there any changes I can make so I don't experience a problem?

Jatin Bidaye

A Your system configuration meets the minimum system requirements of *Age of Empires 3*, so it is able to run on your computer. However, you should keep in mind that the "minimum system configuration" the game developer states is the *absolute minimum* system specifications at which the game can run.

You can't expect it to run in its full glory on such a system—even if certain levels of the game run satisfactorily, at a level with complex details and higher AI requirements, the game might stutter.

Shadows Of The Past

Q I was addicted to porn once upon a time, and that reflects in my browser's Google toolbar: if I want to do a search on "systems," as soon as I type the "s", it brings up a drop-down list of options that indicate objectionable content, which, of course, I'd typed in earlier. What needs to be done to prevent the unwanted lists from coming up?

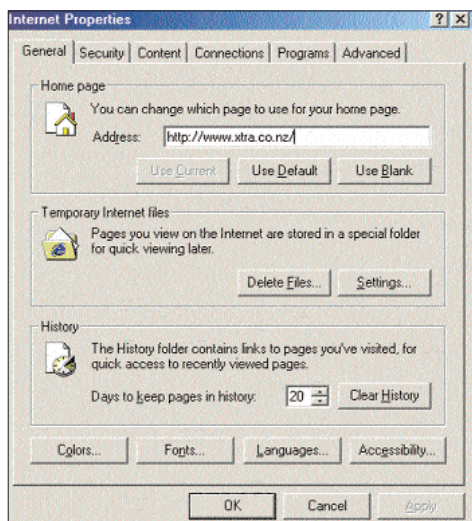
Ajay CK

A We assume you're using IE, since you haven't mentioned what browser you're using. Get rid of the drop-down history in the following way: go to **Control Panel > Internet Options**. In the General tab, under Temporary Internet Files, click on the button that says Delete Files. In the window that pops up, check the box that says "Delete all offline content" and click OK. Further down, you will see a History section. Click on the Clear History button to clear the History folder, which contains links to pages you've visited.

NetNone?

Q I have a dial-up Internet connection from BSNL called NetOne. I use a 56 Kbps internal modem. When I connect, the connection speed shows up as "connected at 40 Kbps," but downloads are very slow. Even when I use a download accelerator such as DAP, I get ridiculously slow download speeds—2 to 3 KBps.

Bipin Thite



The "General" tab under Internet Properties

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

A The connection speed shown is the speed at which the handshake between the modem and the ISP's server has been negotiated. This depends on a variety of factors such as the quality of the telephone line, whether there is noise in the signal, the quality of the modem, and other factors. You might need to check your modem settings, such as the initialisation string, which can be set in Control Panel > Phone and Modem Options. Try to lower the baud rate of the modem to, say, 33.6 kbps and then try to connect. If the modem connects, there is certainly a noise problem with your telephone line: you might need to contact your telephone company for a solution. You could also try plugging the modem into a different PCI slot.

I Screwed Up...

Q I have an ASUS motherboard. I used the ASUS BIOS update utility to download and update my BIOS to the latest version. I could only see a blank screen after I rebooted. The fans spin, and there is no other activity. My motherboard came with the CrashFree BIOS 2 facility. How I can use it to revive the motherboard?

Navraj Singh

A To restore your BIOS using CrashFree BIOS 2, all you need to do is boot the computer using the ASUS support CD. The BIOS will be recovered automatically. But if your system doesn't even reach the stage where it detects the CD as the boot device, your only option is to get the BIOS chip replaced, or re-programmed by a technician.

Perfect Password Protection

Q Is there a way to lock a folder by assigning a password so that the folder will not be accessible without a password even in Windows XP's Safe Mode?

Aadesh Patil

A There are quite a few programs that let you do this. A good program to password-protect your files and folders is Folder Lock, which you can download from www.newsoftwares.net/folderlock/ or Hide Folders XP from www.snapfiles.com/get/hidefoldersxp.html. These programs can hide your files as well as your folders, and it can do this for files on removable drives as well.